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The August guidance: what the Commission's new CBAM rulebook asks of Turkish exporters in the first paying year

Ten guidance documents published on 14 August 2026, and verifier guidance on 24 August, set out how emissions data for 2026 imports should be monitored, calculated and verified.

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Executive summary

1. On 14 August 2026 the European Commission published ten guidance documents for the definitive period of the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM, known in Türkiye as SKDM). They are written mainly for operators of installations outside the EU, which includes Turkish steel, aluminium, cement and fertiliser plants. On 24 August it followed with guidance for verifiers and accreditation bodies.
2. 2026 is the first year in which imports carry a CBAM cost, but the money moves in 2027. EU importers buy certificates from 1 February 2027 and declare and surrender them for 2026 imports by 30 September 2027. Verifiers begin issuing verification reports in the CBAM Registry in January 2027. Emissions data for this year's shipments therefore has to be monitored now and verified early next year.
3. The sound question for a Turkish exporter is not whether CBAM applies to us, but whether our 2026 emissions data will be calculated by the method in the guidance and ready for a verifier in time for our buyers' first declaration.

What was published

Guidance No. 1 introduces CBAM concepts for non-EU operators: the compliance cycle, roles, milestones, deadlines and exemptions in the definitive period. Guidance No. 2 is a quick guide that walks an operator through monitoring for installations producing CBAM goods.

Guidance No. 3 sets out the methods for calculating emissions embedded in goods, with the monitoring and reporting obligations and recommendations for producers. Guidance No. 4 explains the free allocation adjustment, which reduces the number of certificates an importer must surrender to reflect the free allowances still given to EU producers.

Six sector guides, Nos. 5a to 5f, cover cement, hydrogen, fertilisers, iron and steel, aluminium and electricity. Each describes production routes, value chains and monitoring and reporting, with worked examples.

The Commission's announcement asks operators to establish a monitoring plan, to note the changes in the calculation of embedded emissions compared with the transitional period, to focus on using actual values for their 2026 imports and to be well prepared for verification of their emissions data.

The guidance for verifiers and national accreditation bodies of 24 August explains how verifiers of third-country installations are accredited and supervised. Verifiers could apply for access to

the CBAM Registry from 1 September 2026, and verification reports are expected in the Registry from January 2027 so that importers can use verified actual emissions in their declarations.

The guidance explains the CBAM Regulation and its implementing acts; it does not replace them. Where the two differ, the legal texts on EUR-Lex prevail.

The calendar behind the requirement

Importers above the annual threshold of 50 tonnes of CBAM goods must be authorised CBAM declarants. Electricity and hydrogen are covered whatever the volume.

No certificates are bought in 2026. Sales start on 1 February 2027. Certificates for 2026 imports are priced at the quarterly average of EU ETS auction prices for the quarter of import, and from 2027 at a weekly average. The first annual declaration and surrender, covering 2026, is due by 30 September 2027.

The charged share starts small. Because EU producers still receive most of their allowances free, the free allocation adjustment removes most of the obligation in 2026 and less each year until free allocation ends in 2034. The cost per tonne of product therefore rises every year even if the plant's emissions do not change.

Default values are the fallback when actual data is missing. Most of the default values for the definitive period carry a mark-up of 10% in 2026, 20% in 2027 and 30% from 2028, with a separate treatment for fertilisers. A buyer who must rely on defaults pays more each year, and will compare suppliers on that basis.

Where a carbon price has been paid in the country of origin, the CBAM Regulation allows the importer to claim a reduction. Türkiye's emissions trading system is in its pilot phase, so Turkish exporters should follow how the Commission's methodology for that deduction treats it before promising buyers any saving.

The decision behind the requirement

For most Turkish plants the decision is whether to give each EU buyer verified actual values or to let them use defaults. Actual values usually lower the buyer's cost, but only if the data is complete, follows the guidance method and passes verification. A file that fails verification in early 2027 leaves the buyer on defaults for the whole 2026 declaration.

That makes the next few months the practical window. Monitoring plans, data routines for energy, fuels, inputs and precursors, and a verifier engagement have to be in place before the first verification season, not after the first buyer complaint.

There is a commercial side too. EU importers are now building supplier files for their first declaration. A Turkish supplier who can send a complete emissions communication, a monitoring

plan and a named verifier is easier to keep than one who sends spreadsheets, and the difference will show up in the next price conversation.

Five common misreadings

“CBAM costs start in 2027.” The cost attaches to goods imported from 1 January 2026. Certificates are bought and surrendered in 2027, but the emissions that set the bill are this year’s.

“The guidance changes the rules.” It explains the CBAM Regulation and its implementing acts. Obligations come from the legal texts; the guidance shows how the Commission expects them to be applied.

“Our transitional-period reports are enough.” The calculation of embedded emissions has changed for the definitive period, and actual values must now be verified by an accredited verifier.

“Verification can wait until the buyer asks.” Verification reports start in January 2027 and the declaration is due by 30 September 2027. Accredited verifiers for third-country installations are a limited resource in the first season.

“The EU importer handles CBAM.” The importer declares and pays, but only the operator has the plant data. Without it, the importer falls back on default values with a rising mark-up.

Questions for the leadership team

1. Which of our products sold into the EU fall under CBAM, and which sector guide applies to each of them?
2. Do we have a monitoring plan that follows Guidance No. 3 and the sector guide for our production route?
3. Can we calculate embedded emissions for 2026 shipments installation by installation, including precursors bought from other plants?
4. Which EU buyers will use our actual values, and which are planning to use default values?
5. Have we chosen an accredited verifier, and when can they visit and report?
6. Who in the company sends the emissions communication to each buyer, and in what format?
7. Have we compared actual and default values, including the yearly mark-up, for our main products?
8. Do any of our buyers expect a reduction for carbon prices paid in Türkiye, and what have we promised them?

What a good first step produces

A useful first step is a 2026 data check on one product and one EU buyer: the sector guide that applies, the monitoring plan, the data that exists today, the gaps a verifier would find and an actual-versus-default comparison. It should leave the leadership team with a clear view of whether verified actual values are achievable for the first declaration.

Ganrich Advisory runs this as a focused review with your plant, finance and export teams, and coordinates with accredited verifiers where they are needed. We are not a verification body and do not issue verified statements. We share the working method in a conversation rather than in print, because it depends on the installation.

Start a conversation

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About this paper. This paper reflects official sources checked on 25 October 2026. It is general information, not legal, customs, tax or engineering advice. Rules, thresholds and dates change; confirm them against official sources before acting. It describes no client work or results.

Sources: European Commission, guidance documents for CBAM implementation in the definitive period (14 August 2026): taxation-customs.ec.europa.eu/news/european-commission-publishes-series-guidance-documents-support-cbam-implementation-definitive-2026-08-14_en · European Commission, guidance for CBAM verifiers and accreditation bodies (24 August 2026): taxation-customs.ec.europa.eu/news/european-commission-publishes-guidance-cbam-verifiers-and-accreditation-bodies-2026-08-24_en · Regulation (EU) 2023/956 establishing a carbon border adjustment mechanism, as amended: eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2023/956/oj · Regulation (EU) 2025/2083 amending Regulation (EU) 2023/956 (simplification): eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2025/2083/oj

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